

Infancy

During the first year, babies grow quickly but are completely dependent on their parents for care, food, and protection. As their muscles get stronger, infants start to crawl and eventually to walk. They may also speak their first words.

Childhood

Children grow steadily and learn skills, such as running, talking, and reading. They also learn to play with each other. All children develop at different paces.

A baby's head is huge in proportion to its body—so that it can hold its big brain!

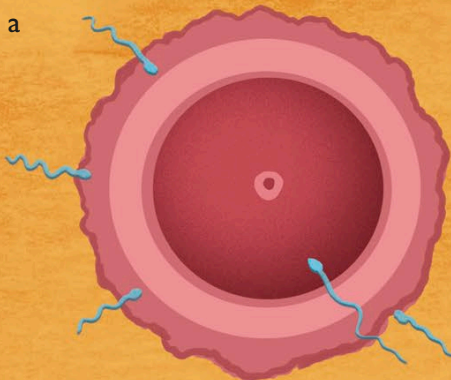
Giving birth

The mother's womb (uterus) contracts to push the baby into the outside world. Like all mammals, the baby is fed with milk. Mothers usually give birth to one baby at a time, sometimes two (twins), or occasionally even more!

Growing up

Teenagers, or adolescents, develop an adult shape and become more independent of their parents. They start to be able to sexually reproduce, in a stage known as puberty.

Fertilization A man and a woman come together to make a baby. One of the female's egg cells joins with a male's sperm cell, in a process called fertilization. This is how all human life starts.



Embryo Inside a female's uterus, the fertilized egg divides again and again to form an embryo, which is a tiny human made of millions of cells. At eight weeks old, the face, limbs, and internal organs are all in place.

